A YEAR OF SMALL STEPS

Performing Artist, 12-month plan

A day in the life

In the 2030s, a performing artist blends live art with advanced technology, using AI tools to design immersive experiences that connect deeply with audiences. They collaborate with intelligent systems to create new forms of expression, focusing on emotional impact and storytelling. Human creativity, empathy, and adaptability remain central, guiding how technology enhances their work without replacing the personal touch.

Skills your child will build

Creative collaboration | Tech integration | Emotional expression | Adaptive communication | Storytelling | Physical conditioning



MONTH 1

Team Story Circle Storyboard

Skill you'll build: Creative collaboration

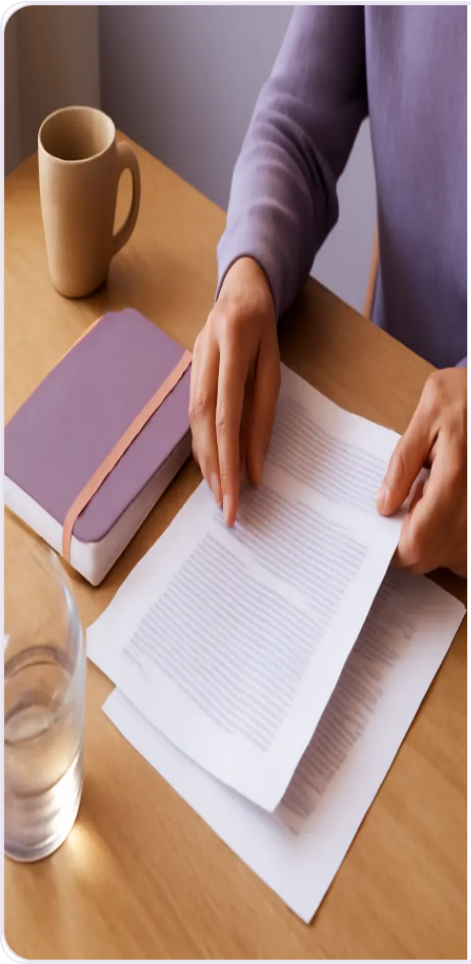
Project details

Gather a small group of friends or classmates and collect at least three personal stories by listening carefully and taking notes. Choose one story to adapt into a short performance and create a detailed storyboard outlining the scenes and key moments. Share the completed storyboard with your group to get feedback and make improvements. This storyboard will be used to guide your group's first collaborative performance.

Success criteria

- Collected at least 3 personal stories
- Created a detailed storyboard for one story
- Presented storyboard and received feedback from group

Time: 3-4 hrs / month



MONTH 2

Digital Mood Board for Performance Concept

Skill you'll build: Tech integration

Project details

Use free online tools or a physical notebook to gather images, sounds, and videos that inspire your upcoming performance idea. Organize these media elements into a cohesive digital or physical mood board that reflects the mood and theme of your concept. Present your mood board to a family member, explaining why you chose each element and how it relates to your performance vision. This mood board will serve as a creative reference for your project.

Success criteria

- Collected diverse images, sounds, and videos
- Organized media into a cohesive mood board
- Explained mood board choices to a family member

Time: 3-4 hrs / month



MONTH 3

Expressive Movement Journal Compilation

Skill you'll build: Emotional expression

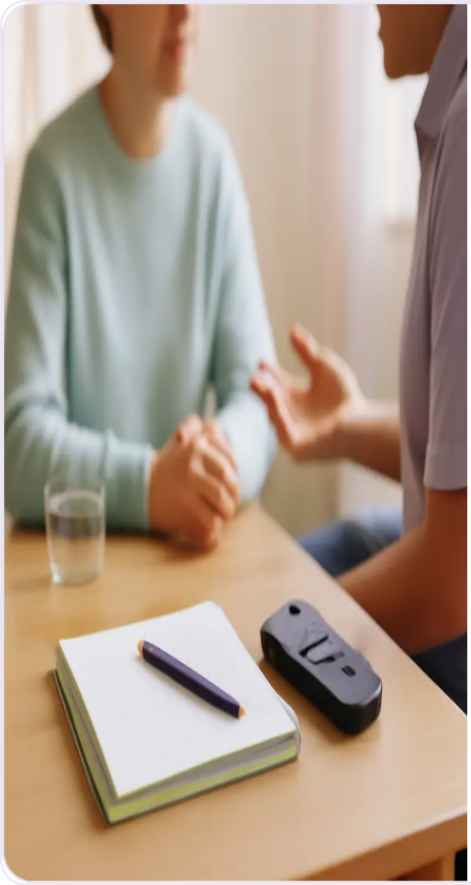
Project details

Practice simple dance or movement exercises daily, focusing on how each movement makes you feel emotionally and physically. Write detailed journal entries describing your feelings and observations after each exercise. Compile these entries into a movement journal that captures your expressive journey. Share your favorite journal entry with a friend or teacher and discuss your experience.

Success criteria

- Completed daily movement exercises
- Wrote detailed journal entries for each session
- Shared a favorite entry with a friend or teacher

Time: 3-4 hrs / month



MONTH 4

Audience Interview Summary Presentation

Skill you'll build: Adaptive communication

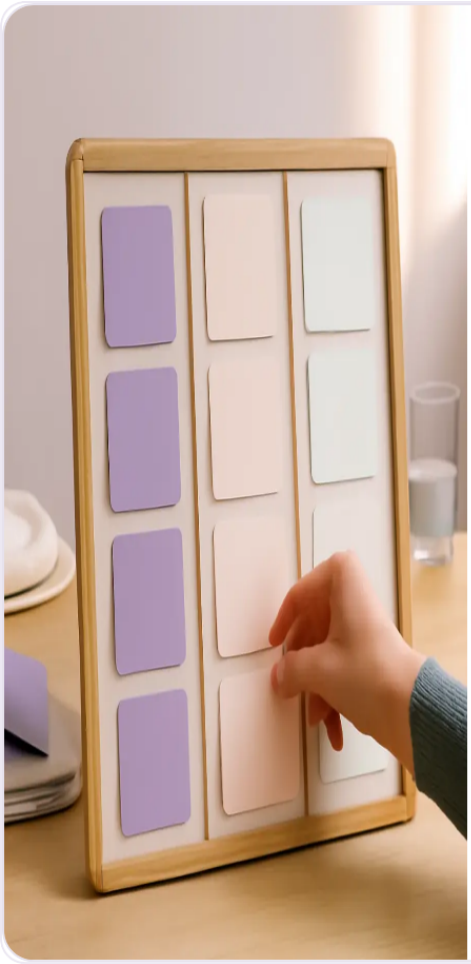
Project details

Interview at least three family members or friends about their favorite performances and what emotions or messages moved them. Record their answers carefully in a notebook. Summarize the key themes and insights from these interviews in a written report. Present your summary to the interviewees, highlighting what you learned about audience impact.

Success criteria

- Conducted interviews with at least 3 people
- Recorded detailed answers in a notebook
- Presented a summary report to the interviewees

Time: 3-4 hrs / month



MONTH 5

Draft Script for 'The Clever Fox' Performance

Skill you'll build: Storytelling

Project details

Write a draft script adapting the folk tale 'The Clever Fox' into a short performance. Use a notebook to outline scenes, characters, and dialogue, including stage directions for actions and emotions. Create a complete script draft that can be used for a small group rehearsal. Share the draft with your drama club members to gather their feedback and suggestions for improvement.

Success criteria

- Completed a draft script of 'The Clever Fox' with scenes and dialogue
- Included clear stage directions
- Received feedback from drama club members

Time: 3-4 hrs / month



MONTH 6

Daily Stretch and Strength Routine Plan

Skill you'll build: Physical conditioning

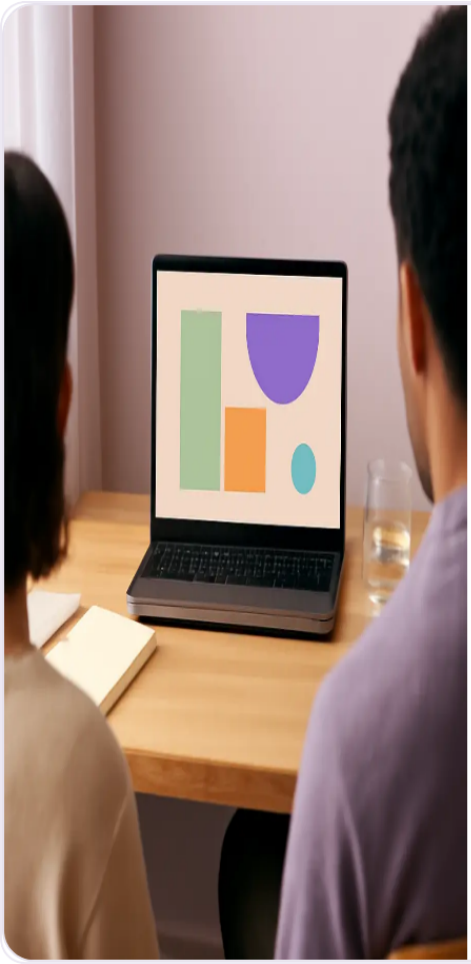
Project details

Design a daily 15-minute stretching and strengthening routine tailored to improve your physical fitness for performing arts. Write down the exercises and sequence in a notebook, including notes on form and repetitions. Track your progress daily by recording how you feel and any improvements. Share your routine and progress with a family member, explaining the benefits for your performance skills.

Success criteria

- Designed a clear daily routine with exercises
- Tracked progress consistently in a notebook
- Explained routine and benefits to a family member

Time: 3-4 hrs / month



MONTH 7

Collaborative Mini-Performance Video Project

Skill you'll build: Creative collaboration

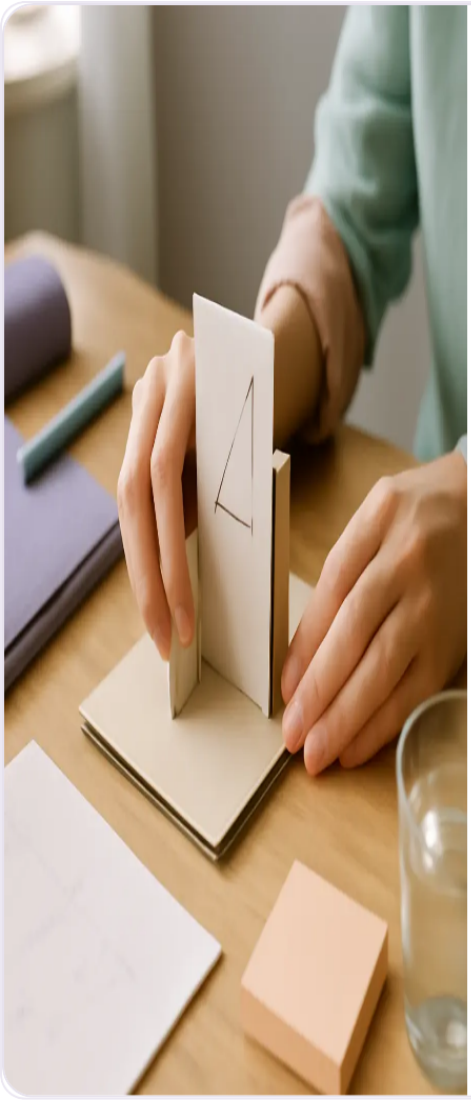
Project details

Work with your group to create a 5-minute mini-performance that combines storytelling, movement, and technology elements like music or lighting. Plan and rehearse the piece together, refining each part. Perform the mini-performance live for family or classmates and record the entire performance on video. Review the video as a group to discuss strengths and areas for improvement.

Success criteria

- Created a 5-minute group performance combining multiple elements
- Performed live for an audience
- Recorded the performance for review

Time: 3-4 hrs / month



MONTH 8

Build and Demonstrate a DIY Light and Sound Performance Setup

Skill you'll build: Tech integration

Project details

Design and assemble a simple lighting and sound setup using household items like lamps and smartphone apps for sound effects. Test the setup during a rehearsal to see how it enhances the mood of your performance. Record a short demonstration video explaining how your setup works and how it improves the show. Present the video to your performance group and collect their feedback for further improvements.

Success criteria

- Built a DIY light and sound setup using household items and apps
- Tested the setup during rehearsal
- Presented a demonstration video to the performance group and gathered feedback

Time: 3-4 hrs / month



MONTH 9

Record and Share a Monologue Emotion Performance Video

Skill you'll build: Emotional expression

Project details

Choose a short monologue and practice performing it with different emotional expressions such as happiness, sadness, and anger. Record a video of your performance showing these varied emotions clearly. Watch the video to evaluate your emotional expression and note areas to improve. Share the video with a trusted adult, like a teacher or family member, and ask for specific feedback on your emotional delivery.

Success criteria

- Practiced a monologue with varied emotional expressions
- Recorded a video performance demonstrating these emotions
- Received specific feedback from a trusted adult

Time: 3-4 hrs / month



MONTH 10

Audience Feedback Survey Report

Skill you'll build: Adaptive communication

Project details

After performing a small show, create a simple paper or digital survey to collect feedback from your audience about your performance. Distribute the survey to viewers and collect their responses. Analyze the feedback to identify strengths and areas for improvement. Present your findings and suggestions to your performance group for future growth.

Success criteria

- Created and distributed an audience feedback survey
- Collected and organized survey responses
- Presented analysis and suggestions to group

Time: 3-4 hrs / month



MONTH 11

Original Storytelling Performance Piece

Skill you'll build: Storytelling

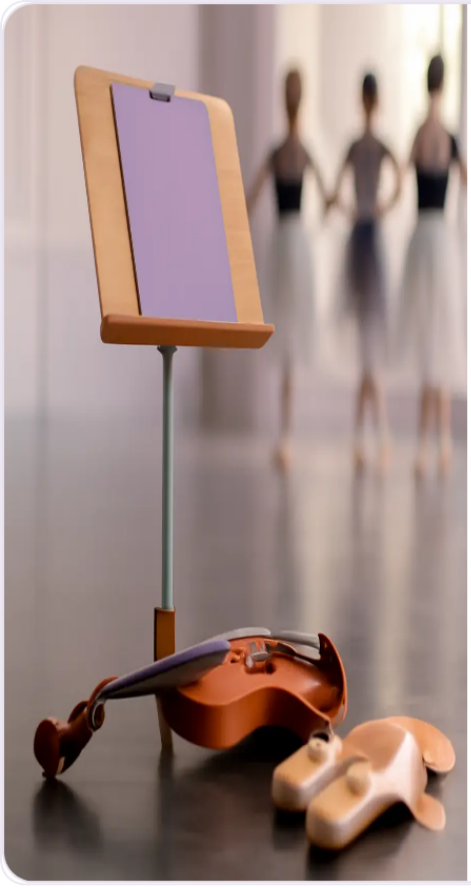
Project details

Write an original storytelling piece that incorporates personal or cultural themes important to you. Practice performing the piece using expressive gestures and vocal variety to engage your audience. Perform your storytelling piece live for family or classmates. After the performance, ask for and record feedback to help improve your skills.

Success criteria

- Completed an original storytelling script
- Practiced expressive performance techniques
- Performed live and collected audience feedback

Time: 3-4 hrs / month



MONTH 12

Endurance Dance Routine Performance

Skill you'll build: Physical conditioning

Project details

Choreograph a 3-minute dance routine designed to challenge and build your stamina and strength. Practice the routine regularly, focusing on endurance and technique. Perform the routine live for family or friends, demonstrating your progress. After the performance, discuss your experience and improvements with your audience.

Success criteria

- Choreographed a 3-minute endurance dance routine
- Practiced regularly to build stamina
- Performed routine live and discussed progress

Time: 3-4 hrs / month